

"I HAVE BEEN GIVEN NO CHANCE TO EXPLAIN."

Natwar Singh

The expose on former External Affairs Minister Natwar Singh's involvement in helping his son Jagat get contracts under the UN oil-for-food programme in Iraq published in INDIA TODAY led to his resignation from the Cabinet, and the Congress. His role had first been mentioned in the Volcker Report which revealed those who had made illegal payments to the Saddam Hussein regime. While Singh continues to protest his innocence, the INDIA TODAY revelations showed otherwise.



BANDEEP SINGH



BHASKAR PAUL

PARTING WAYS

"There are ownership issues". With that remark to a TV channel, Mukesh Ambani, elder son of the founder of Reliance Industries, Dhirusbhai Ambani, confirmed talk about the Rs 90,000-crore Reliance empire being headed for a split. With matriarch Kokilaben as referee, the group was divided between Mukesh and brother Anil, but not before dirty linen was washed in public.

MASTERLY KNOCK

Master Blaster, The Little Master; the accolades and titles that came Sachin Tendulkar's way were well deserved. No other contemporary batsman has electrified the cricket stadium like the Indian superstar. The statistics speak for themselves. In December 2005, he set the record for the highest number of Test centuries (35), overtaking compatriot Sunil Gavaskar and West Indian rival Brian Lara. He currently has 37 test centuries to his name. He also holds the record for most one-day centuries (41) and was the first batsman in the world to go past 10,000 runs in one-day internationals, in March 2001, against world champions Australia.



SUMIT INDIGER SINGH

ELSEWHERE

- January 30 saw the first 'free' Parliamentary elections in Iraq since 1958.
- Suspected masterminds behind Air India's Flight 182 Kanishka bombing, Ripudaman Singh Malik and Ajaib Singh Bagri were acquitted of all charges on March 16.
- Four explosions rocked London on July 7, injuring 700 and killing 56. Three of the

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bombs were placed in the underground train network, while a fourth exploded on a bus.

- Three explosions in Bali on October 1, killed 26 people and injured more than 100.

\$10

billion (Rs 400 crore) was the foreign institutional investment inflows compared to \$8.51 billion (Rs 345 crore) in 2004. In the same year, the Sensex also hit a record high of 9,394.27.